Beyond Emission Rankings

Are Countries Making Progress on Climate Action?

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1. Project Summary

Climate action requires more than identifying the countries with the highest CO2 emissions. This project investigates which countries are reducing their emissions over time and whether total emissions and emissions per capita tell different stories. It also explores the relationship between GDP per capita and CO2 emissions. The aim is to provide a clearer perspective on global climate progress and Sustainable Development Goal 13 (Climate Action).

2. Data Sources

The project will use the Our World in Data CO2 and Greenhouse Gas Emissions dataset. It provides historical country-level emissions, population, and economic indicators, drawing on established research sources including the Global Carbon Project.

Indicator	Interactive Graph
Annual CO2 emissions	Explore graph
CO2 emissions per capita	Explore graph
CO2 emissions and GDP	Explore graph

Dataset and documentation: Our World in Data - CO2 Data

3. Planned Approach

The final poster will include four visualization types: a line chart showing emission trends, a bar chart comparing countries, a world map displaying per-capita emissions, and a scatter plot examining the relationship between GDP and CO2 emissions. These visualizations will reveal differences in national emission patterns.

4. Conclusion

Comparing total emissions, per-capita emissions, and economic indicators can provide a more balanced understanding of climate progress. This project aims to show why meaningful climate action requires examining both emission levels and changes over time.